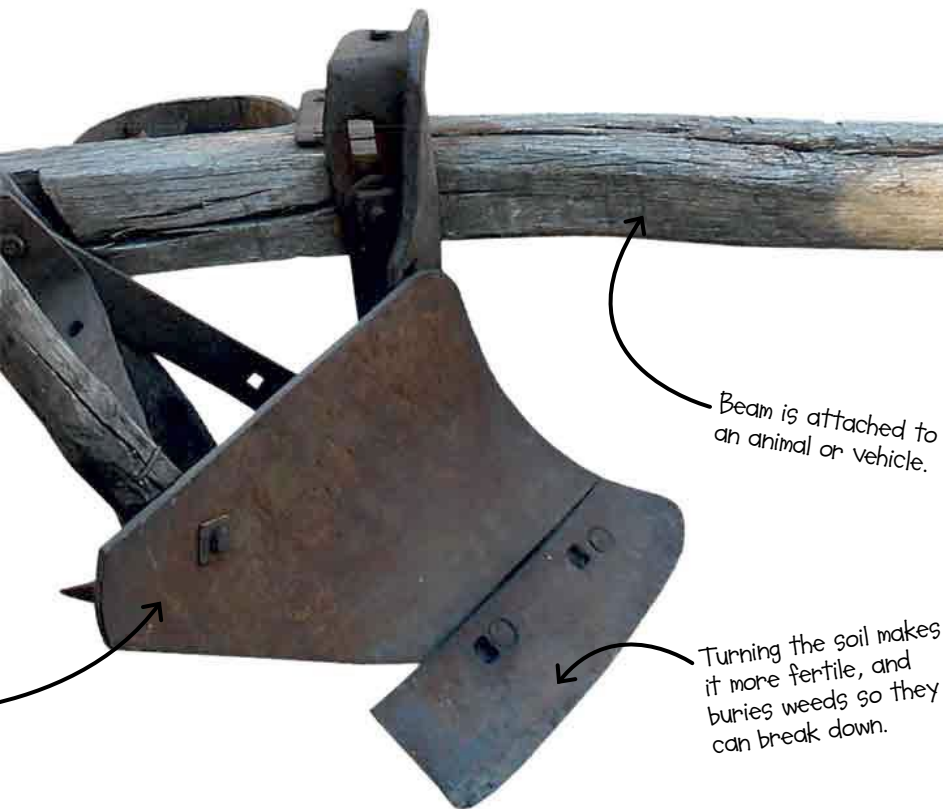


How it changed the world

The plow was a huge boost to farming communities, enabling agricultural production on a grand scale. Vast areas of land could be farmed by fewer people, resulting in much larger harvests.

Steam-powered plows

By the 1860s, the **invention of the steam engine** made animals the second choice for pulling plows. English engineer **JOHN FOWLER** devised the **double-engine system**, in which steam engines on both sides of a field pulled “anti-balance” plows on a steel rope. These **tipped at each end** so the land could be plowed back and forth, producing **SIX FURROWS** at a time. Fowler’s plows were exported to Europe and Africa, but the expense meant that only large farms used them.



Today, **TRACTORS** pull large metal plows. Although this **HEAVY-DUTY MACHINERY** does the hard work, the basic principle remains the same.



The benefits of plowing led to **CROP ROTATION**, ensuring fertile soil and bountiful harvests. Rapid food production led to **INDUSTRIAL-SCALE FARMING**.

